Abdul-Aziz Mimbantas

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Abdul-Aziz Mimbantas

Aleem Abdulaziz S. Mimbantas (d. 2012) was a Filipino Moro revolutionary leader, Islamic scholar, and senior official of the Moro Islamic Liberation Front (MILF). He served as Vice Chairman for Military Affairs and was a key figure in the Bangsamoro armed struggle and subsequent peace negotiations with the Philippine government. <ref name="pia2024">Philippine Information Agency. *Healthcare workers in Lanao del Sur push for a new hospital in Masiu*. August 15, 2024.</ref><ref name="gulfnews2018">Felongco, G. *Senior MILF official dies of heart attack*. Gulf News, 2018.</ref>

Early Life and Background

- Abdulaziz Mimbantas was a native of Masiu, Lanao del Sur, a stronghold of the Maranao people and an important area in the Moro resistance movement.<ref name="pia2024" />
- He was trained in Islamic scholarship, earning the title “Aleem,” reflecting his deep grounding in Islamic teachings and leadership within the Moro community.
- His early life was shaped by the political and social struggles of the Bangsamoro people during the post-colonial Philippine period.

Role in the Moro Islamic Liberation Front

- Mimbantas became one of the senior leaders of the MILF under Chairman Salamat Hashim.
- He served as **Vice Chairman for Military Affairs**, overseeing aspects of the Bangsamoro Islamic Armed Forces (BIAF).<ref name="pia2024" /><ref name="gulfnews2018" />
- He also played a role in the MILF peace negotiations with the Philippine government, contributing to dialogue efforts that would later lead to the Bangsamoro peace process.<ref name="gulfnews2018" />

- As a close associate of Salamat Hashim, he was instrumental in sustaining the organization’s structure and strategy during critical periods of armed struggle and negotiation.

Death

- Abdulaziz Mimbantas died in 2012 from cardiac arrest following engagements related to peace and development efforts.<ref name="gulfnews2018" />
- In accordance with Islamic tradition, he was buried shortly after his death in Camp Bushra Somiorang in Butig, Lanao del Sur, near the grave of Salamat Hashim.<ref name="gulfnews2018" />

Legacy

- Mimbantas is remembered as one of the central military and ideological leaders of the MILF.
- His contributions to both armed resistance and peace negotiations helped shape the trajectory of the Bangsamoro struggle for self-determination.

- His legacy continues to be honored in the Bangsamoro region:

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 * His burial site, together with that of Salamat Hashim, has been declared a protected heritage and memorial site under Bangsamoro law.<ref name="baa60">Bangsamoro Autonomy Act No. 60, 2024.</ref>
 * A hospital in Masiu, Lanao del Sur has been established in his honor, recognizing his service to the Bangsamoro people.<ref name="pia2024" />
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Significance in Bangsamoro History

- Abdulaziz Mimbantas represents the generation of Moro leaders who transitioned from armed struggle to political negotiation.
- His role helped lay the groundwork for later agreements such as the Comprehensive Agreement on the Bangsamoro and the establishment of the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao.

References

<references> <ref name="pia2024">Philippine Information Agency. *Healthcare workers in Lanao del Sur push for a new hospital in Masiu*. August 15, 2024.</ref> <ref name="gulfnews2018">Felongco, G. *Senior MILF official dies of heart attack*. Gulf News, 2018.</ref> <ref name="baa60">Bangsamoro Autonomy Act No. 60. Official Gazette of the Bangsamoro Government, 2024.</ref> </references>

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